MANDI LU

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Architecture student exploring the intersection of storytelling, technology, and human experience through spatial design, set design, and interdisciplinary collaboration

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA 08/2025 - 05/2030
Bachelor of Architecture, 4.00 GPA

- Activities: Elected Class Representative, *Student Advisory Council;* Editor, *Inter-punct Magazine*; Lighting Designer, *Scotch n' Soda Theatre Company*; Thrill Design Competition Team Member, *Theme Park Entertainment Group*; Member, *National Organization of Minority Architects*

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Psyche Inspired Intern, NASA 09/2026 - Present

- Collaborate with NASA Psyche mission scientists, artists, and interdisciplinary team members through weekly discussions to translate complex scientific concepts into visual narratives
- Develop original artwork inspired by mission research and team conversations to promote public engagement and communicate the mission's scientific goals
- Bridge science and creative storytelling by transforming technical subject matter into accessible, engaging content for diverse audiences

Architecture Intern, RCF Group 05/2026 - 08/2026

- Produced Shop Drawings and renderings using Configura CET and AutoCAD for clients in banking, healthcare, and the food industry, ensuring all program standards are upheld
- Received construction documents from clients and defined the scope of work
- Assisted with the design and documentation of interior demountable wall systems and shading solutions for clients
- Conducted on-site field measurements to verify project dimensions and ensure drawing accuracy throughout the design and construction process

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Creative Team, Lunar Gala 09/2026 - Present

- Hand-selected from a competitive pool to design and fabricate the set of Pittsburgh's largest student-produced fashion show.
- Collaborate with fashion designers, lighting and sound teams, and models to develop an immersive, dynamic set that integrates spatial design with live performance.

Design Team, CMU Asian Student Association Carnival Booth 11/2025 - 05/2026

- Designed and constructed an award-winning full-scale temporary event structure for CMU Carnival, contributing to concept development, fabrication, and team coordination
- Contributed to the design of an immersive, story-centered event environment, translating a popular cultural theme into a large-scale physical experience for guests
- Balanced safety requirements, budget constraints, and tight production timelines while collaborating with a multidisciplinary student team

AWARDS AND PUBLICATIONS

Published Researcher and UPenn Conference Invitee, *"Algorithms, Architecture, aaand Action: The Evolving Role of AI in Cinematic Architecture," WOVEN: An Interdisciplinary Journal of Dietrich College*
2026 Thrill Design Competition Finalist Team*, Toronto Metropolitan University*
Runner-Up*, CMU Carnival Booth Awards, Asian Student Association Booth*
2025 U.S. Presidential Scholar Semi-Finalist (620 selected nationally)*, United States Department of Education*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Adobe InDesign, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, AutoCAD, Bluebeam, Canva, ChatGPT, Figma, Google Workspace, KeyShot, Microsoft Office Suite, Miro, Notion, Revit, Rhinoceros 3D, SketchUp, 3D Rendering, Unity, Vectorworks